

# How The Independent Executive Compares

We reviewed about 45 programs across career/outplacement, fractional-consulting, and AI-for-leaders. None teaches all five skills, and none prepares an executive for both a promotion and an independent practice.

|                    | The Independent Executive                        | TalentGuy                 | RiseSmart Premier             | Right Management         | Find My Profession               | Pavilion      | Chief              | Consulting Success | Fractional Exec Connection | Pathway to Fractional | Dorie Clark | #befractional    | Fractional Officer | Going Fractional | Consulting Bridge     | Mastery Insights        | BetterUp / CoachHub | MIT xPRO / Wharton |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------|--------------------|--------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------|-------------|------------------|--------------------|------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| Price              | \$6,800 founding \$10,000 list                   | \$10,500 120 days         | \$6,499 / 12 mo employer-paid | Not public employer-paid | \$3,000/mo or \$1.5K+8%          | \$2,700 / yr  | ~\$5,800 / yr 2023 | Five figures       | \$47/mo – \$12K+           | \$3K / \$5K           | \$2,495     | \$875 + \$875 AI | \$379              | £300             | \$67 – \$1,297        | \$6,000 / yr + \$349/mo | B2B only            | \$850 – \$13,500   |
| Value proposition  | ✓                                                | ✓                         | Partial                       | Partial                  | Partial                          | Partial       | —                  | ✓                  | ✓                          | ✓                     | Partial     | ✓                | ✓                  | ✓                | ✓                     | Partial                 | —                   | —                  |
| Executive presence | ✓<br>weekly call                                 | Partial<br>pitch only     | Partial                       | Partial                  | —                                | —             | Partial            | —                  | —                          | —                     | Partial     | —                | —                  | —                | —                     | ✓                       | ✓                   | —                  |
| Consulting         | ✓                                                | ✓                         | Partial<br>mention            | Partial<br>no curriculum | —                                | ✓<br>GTM only | Partial            | ✓                  | ✓                          | ✓                     | Partial     | ✓                | ✓                  | ✓                | Partial               | —                       | —                   | —                  |
| Brand & outreach   | ✓                                                | ✓                         | ✓                             | ✓                        | ✓                                | Partial       | Partial            | Partial            | ✓                          | ✓                     | ✓           | Partial          | Partial            | ✓                | —                     | Partial                 | —                   | —                  |
| Agentic AI         | ✓<br>AI Lab + Sherpa                             | ✓                         | —                             | —                        | —                                | ✓             | Partial            | ✓                  | Partial                    | —                     | Partial     | ✓                | ✓<br>lead agents   | Partial          | ✓                     | —                       | Partial             | ✓                  |
| Career             | ✓                                                | —<br>excludes job seekers | ✓                             | ✓                        | ✓                                | ✓<br>CMO/CRO  | Partial            | —                  | —                          | —                     | Partial     | —                | —                  | —                | ✓<br>while you search | ✓                       | Partial             | —                  |
| Guarantee          | Promoted, new job, or \$10K — or we keep working | Until first client        | None                          | None                     | 5 interviews or an offer in 4 mo | None          | None; women only   | None               | None                       | Refund thru wk 4      | No refunds  | None             | 30-day refund      | 14-day refund    | None                  | None                    | None                | None               |

Key: ✓ yes Partial partial — no. The five skills: value proposition, executive presence, consulting, brand & outreach, and agentic AI.

Also reviewed, mostly single-lane: Korn Ferry Advance, LHH, BlueSteps, Ivy Exec, ExecThread, Cultivated Culture, The Muse, Executive Career Brand, Voyageur U, Connectd, Fractional Institute, Fractional Executive Institute, Alan Weiss, Harvard DCE consulting, Justin Welsh LinkedIn OS, Escape the City, Endeavor Executive, Chief Outsiders, GoFractional, Catalant, Fractionals United, Vistage, YPO, EO, HBS PLD, Section AI, ExecOnline, and Maven agentic-AI cohorts. None teaches all five skills plus the leverage model.

Based on each program's public pages as of September 21, 2026. Prices from vendor pages unless noted.